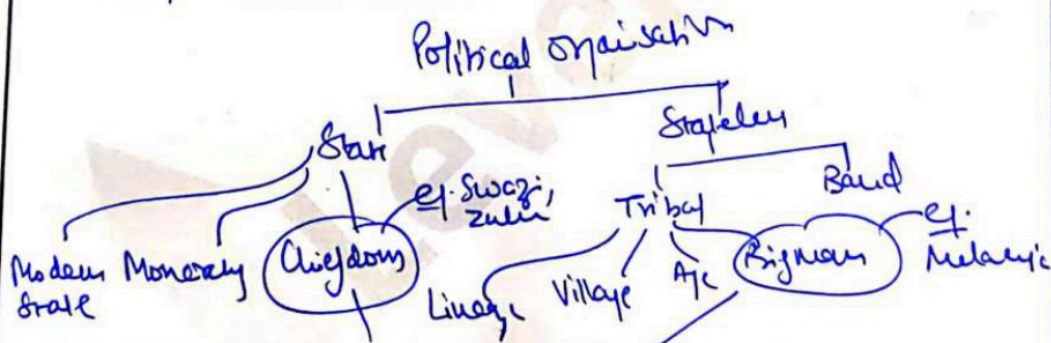


5.b) Big Man based society and Chiefdom

Big man based society and chiefdom are types of political organisations. Political organisation as per John Bertie is the organisation to maintain orderly social relation in a defined/undefined territory between social groups.

As per Timan Service →



Similarities between both
~~Both there are hence related~~

* Big Man of Melanesia — charismatic leadership same as chiefdom (often)

— Big Man often cares less about welfare of society and more about personal gain and same has been observed in chiefdom often

Differences

① Authority — Big man — decentralised → not true authority
Chiefdom — true centralised authority

② Territory there in chiefdom unlike Big man

③ Inheritance of authority is hereditary in chiefdom unlike Big man

Big man may rise or fall depending on his acts. He has loyal fan base which might die down soon

④ Chiefdom has complex ~~for~~ political structure for maintaining social order unlike Big man, for dispute resolution.

Big man if influential enough with permanent following might centralise the tribe to establish authority of his own in a permanent sense but still chiefdom is much higher in complexity.

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